

display capable of displaying seven lines of text. The backlight is feeble, but lights up the entire screen evenly. The flip cover also comes with an external LCD that lets you see the caller's number without opening the phone.

The menu structure is extremely simple with large self-explanatory icons. The touch screen makes navigation very simple, but the absence of a keypad takes some time to get used to.

The phone-PDA combination gives the A388 the extra edge when it comes to information management. Entering the information using the touch screen requires some practice, though the phone does a decent job at character recognition. The phone can gulp down a humongous 1000 detailed entries, apart from the memory space for SMS, e-mails and graphics. It supports six different e-mail accounts, using nearly all protocols such as POP3, IMAP, etc. It offers neat calendaring options, a calculator, to-do list, call history, plus it lets you download Java-based applications.

It has an IrDA port and a serial cable for data communication with a PC. It is also GPRS-enabled for faster data transfer.

During the test we noticed that the phone can either be used as a PDA or a phone and not both simultaneously, which is the biggest drawback. The signal reception and the voice clarity were fairly good. At Rs 19,995, it is a decent deal, especially when you think it as a combo and not as just a cell phone.

Motorola C350

Price: Rs 9,795 B+

The C350 is a sleek looking phone, with a nice use of colours on its outer shell. The keys are radically designed with curves flowing over them, but the ergonomics of the keypad is not up to the mark. The menu navigation is achieved using a four-way key and two dedicated soft menu buttons. The menu is simple, intuitive and self explanatory.

The C350 has many features built into it, the most visible of them being the 4,096 colour LCD display capable of displaying three lines of text. It also sports SMS, EMS, SMS chat, group SMS and long messages of up to 450 characters.

The phone features an address book capacity of 250, apart from the SIM capacity. It also has a weekly calendar view to schedule your appointments, reminders etc.

The C350 features a vast range of multimedia features including polyphonic ring tones (60 total—30 in-built and 30 downloadable), interchangeable covers, downloadable screen-savers and themes, as well as other multimedia enhancements. Other nifty features such as voice dialling, Java support, WAP 1.2.1 and GPRS support, further enhance the feature list of this phone. However, the phone does not have an IrDA port for data connectivity.

The C350 does come with a mini USB connector at the base, which is a good feature to directly connect to the PC. It has decent signal reception, and fairly good voice quality; only when the signal strength decreases considerably, does the speech quality get hampered.

Overall, a good phone with loads of features, decent looks

and a terrific price, at just Rs 9,795 it gives the most bang for the buck. The C350 has rivals in the form of the Sony Ericsson T310, which —apart from the same features— provides an IrDA port, WAP 2.0 support, and is also priced somewhere around Rs 9,500. The deciding factor between them are the looks.

Motorola T 720

Price: Rs 15,995 B

The T 720 is one of the most beautiful looking and functional phones from Motorola. This phone has an amazing mixture of looks, cutting edge technology and usability that is seldom seen on any other phone. Flip open the phone and feast your eyes on the neat laid out keypad, the four-way navigation keys, and the large soft menu keys. The build quality is excellent—the phone feels rugged and solid. The large colour LCD display is beautiful, with everything showing up wonderfully bright, crisp and clear. The display is capable of displaying 9 lines of text, which really helps in reading long SMS messages since it requires minimum scrolling.

The T720 employs an icon-based menu structure that is simple to use and intuitive. The user interface is exceptional with excellent use of directional keypad and soft menu keys. You can even assign six favourite functions to the keys—four for the directional key and two from the two soft menu buttons. As if that wasn't enough, voice command activation is also possible. The keypad buttons are large and easy to use with good touch feedback—the only sore point was the directional keys, which aren't suitable to play the games.

The phone comes with a mammoth 1.75 MB of memory, that can store all the downloaded games, applications, themes, wallpapers, pictures etc. On the entertainment front, the phone comes with three pre-installed Java based games—*MotoGP*, the evergreen *Tetris* and *Astros-mash*. It does have a date book option, but Motorola has not provided a monthly view that would have complemented the large screen well.

The phone supports WAP 1.2.1 and has GPRS. The only thing missing from this phone is an IrDA port and hence, if you have to download, your only option is the cable connection or WAP. It also supports an external FM radio set thus turning it into personal radio on the go.

The T 720 has excellent signal reception and good speech clarity. At Rs 15,995, the phone is priced on the higher side, but it makes up for with its beauty, excellent display screen and loads of features.

